

## Anthony Birleffi

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### Senior Front-End Engineer | Engineering Leader

Experienced front-end engineering leader with **15+ years of expertise** in architecting, developing, and optimizing high-performance web applications. Proven ability to **mentor teams, drive innovation, and implement scalable solutions** that enhance user experience and operational efficiency. Passionate about **emerging technologies (AI/ML, LLMs), design systems, and agile leadership** in both **startup and enterprise environments**.

### Core Competencies & Technical Expertise

- **Leadership & Mentorship:** Team building, coaching junior engineers, technical leadership, stakeholder collaboration.
- **Front-End Development:** JavaScript, TypeScript, React.js, Angular, Vue.js, Next.js, Redwood.js, Storybook, Tailwind CSS
- **Software Architecture:** Component libraries, scalable applications, CI/CD pipelines, performance optimization.
- **DevOps & Cloud Technologies:** AWS, Docker, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Elasticsearch.
- **Emerging Tech:** AI/ML, LLMs, OpenAI, Google Gemini, ChatGPT.

### Professional Experience

#### Senior Front-End Engineer

**Catch & Release** | San Francisco, CA | **05/2022 – Present**

*User-Generated Content Licensing | SaaS Startup*

- Used **Figma**, to help design and development a pattern library with design tokens, for Storybook and continuous UI/UX interfaces. Along with additional user flow explorations.
- Developed and maintained Catch & Release's **React + TypeScript** application, enhancing user experience and platform performance.
- Managed complex application state using Zustand for its lightweight and unopinionated architecture, ensuring predictable state flow across components.
- Led the **creation and optimization** of a reusable component library (Vanilla Extract, Sprinkles, Storybook), reducing development time by **40%**.
- Designed and developed robust, high-performance RESTful and GraphQL APIs using Node.js to serve data to the front-end application, improving data response times by 40%.
- Owned the full-stack development of new features, building the front-end in React and creating the supporting backend services and microservices using Node.js.
- Improved **application performance** by **30%** through UI optimizations and iterative two-week sprints.
- Collaborated daily with a globally distributed team (engineering, product, design) across multiple time zones to coordinate development efforts and ensure project alignment.
- Practiced test-driven development (TDD) within an agile framework, writing Jest unit tests before feature implementation to ensure code reliability.
- Managed the software development lifecycle using Jira, tracking tasks, bugs, and sprint progress to maintain team velocity and transparency.
- Presented technical proposals, project updates, and product demos to senior executives and non-technical stakeholders to drive decision-making and secure buy-in.

- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using **Redwood.js, Docker, and GitHub Actions**, accelerating deployment cycles.
- Utilized debugging tools like Charles Proxy to inspect network traffic, mock API responses, and diagnose mobile and web application issues effectively.
- Developed and consumed GraphQL APIs to efficiently fetch data for React components, minimizing over-fetching and improving data management.
- Developed internal tools with **Python, Golang, DaisyUI, and Templ**, improving business process efficiency by **25%**. Collaborated with the backend engineering team to create efficient multiple API micro service endpoints. To help optimize the internal “TeamApp” and our Frontend application as well.
- Led the development of key features for the company's customer-facing React Native mobile application, contributing to a 20% increase in user engagement.
- Engineered and maintained a shared component library used across our React web and React Native mobile applications, reducing code duplication and accelerating feature development by 30%.
- **Mentored 2-3 junior developers**, driving team skill growth and best practice adoption.

## Senior Developer

**HZDG** | Rockville, MD | **12/2021 – 05/2022**

*Marketing & Digital Experience Agency*

- Engineered high-performance marketing applications for **Kawasaki Motors & Baltimore Tourism Board** using **React, Next.js, and Sanity CMS**.
- Implemented **server-side rendering (SSR)**, improving load times by **35%** and enhancing SEO rankings.
- Led a **remote team of developers**, establishing best practices for maintainable code and efficient workflows.
- **Mentored junior developers**, improving code quality and team velocity.

## Senior Developer | Team Lead

**Creed Interactive** | St. Paul, MN | **06/2018 – 12/2021**

*Enterprise Application Development | Digital Agency*

- **Led the front-end development team** in delivering enterprise eCommerce and web applications, leveraging **React, Angular, and React Native**.
- Designed and optimized CI/CD pipelines for **6-8 projects**, reducing deployment failures by **50%**.
- Spearheaded the development of **Delta Dental's internal application**, streamlining business operations and **improving process efficiency by 40%**.
- **Managed and mentored** a team of **6-10 developers**, fostering a high-performance engineering culture.
- Various full stack applications built with **PHP** and **C#.NET** as well, creating microservice **APIs** that my front-end applications would talk to.

## Founder | Lead Developer

**PlanetMae Web Solutions** | Woodville, WI | **2016 – Present**

*Web Hosting & Website Support Business*

- Founded and operated a **web hosting and development consultancy**, supporting **small businesses and startups** with secure and scalable websites.
- Developed and maintained **custom WordPress & Drupal** solutions, optimizing performance and security.
- Implemented **SEO and accessibility best practices**, improving client site performance and search rankings.
- Provided **technical strategy consulting** for clients, advising on **infrastructure, UI/UX, and emerging web technologies**.
- I created an exercise application in **React Native**, a few years ago. Currently, I'm building/learning/experimenting with an application in **React Native** to detect home appliances via AR. The app is designed to detect real-time feedback on the condition of the appliances in the home.

## Front-End Developer | Director of Development

### Westwerk, MJ Kretsinger, (Various Roles) | 2010 – 2016

Marketing & Digital Agencies

- Developed **marketing websites and enterprise solutions** using **PHP, WordPress, Drupal, and JavaScript frameworks with Vue.js, Angular, and React.js**.
- Conducted **peer code reviews and performance optimizations**, ensuring high-quality, maintainable code.
- Collaborated with **designers, project managers, and QA teams** to deliver visually stunning and functional web experiences.

## Education

### Master's in Science & Engineering, Management of Technology

University of Minnesota - Twin Cities | Expected Graduation: 05/2026

### Bachelor's in Fine Arts, Multimedia & Technical Writing

University of Colorado at Denver

### Associate's Degree in General Studies, Computer Science

Community College of Denver

## Technologies & Tools

**Languages & Frameworks:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, React.js, Angular, Vue.js, Next.js, Redwood.js, React Native, Golang, Python.

**DevOps & Cloud:** AWS, Docker, Azure, Google Cloud, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Elasticsearch.

**AI & ML:** AI Prompt Engineering, LLMs, OpenAI, Google Gemini, ChatGPT.

**CMS & Platforms:** WordPress, Drupal, Magento, Shopify, Sanity CMS, Contentful.

**Performance & Testing:** Jest, REST APIs, GraphQL, Netlify, Google Search Console.

**Design & UX Tools:** Storybook, Sketch, Figma, Vanilla Extract, Sprinkles, DaisyUI, Templ.

**Database:** MongoDB, MySQL, SQL

## Key Skills

- **Technical Leadership & Mentorship** – Developing high-performing teams through knowledge sharing and mentorship.
- **Front-End Architecture & Performance Optimization** – Designing scalable, reusable component libraries for enterprise applications.
- **CI/CD & DevOps Efficiency** – Implementing automated pipelines to streamline software delivery.
- **Scalable Application Development** – Driving agile methodologies for fast, iterative product development.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration** – Partnering with stakeholders to align technical solutions with business goals.
- **AI & Emerging Technologies** – Exploring and integrating AI/ML for innovation in web development.